

Youth Jobs Guarantee

A guaranteed job for every young person in Aotearoa

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Green



With more than one in three young people short of work, the Green Party will guarantee every young person who wants to work a pathway into a decent job, fixing and improving things in their own community.

The Green Party will ensure local jobs, working with councils in every district.

Every 16-to-24-year-old who has been out of work for six months will be guaranteed a pathway into a locally based job or training.

There is no shortage of work to do in New Zealand—things that need fixing, nature that needs protecting, and people who need to be cared for.

Every community can identify stop banks that need upgrading before the next storm, a kaumātua who needs company, and a local playground that needs repairs. All around the motu, there is infrastructure and nature in need of maintenance and renewal, and critical community services held back by a lack of labour.

When there is so much work to be done, it doesn't make sense for nearly 100,000 young people to not be in employment, education or training. Our young people are being denied important opportunities at a critical time in their lives.

Youth unemployment is at nearly 15 percent, roughly three times that of the wider working age population, which is at an 11-year high.

Too many young graduates are applying for hundreds of jobs in a year, only to win a couple of job offers at best—with some of them leaving Aotearoa New Zealand when the hunt becomes too hard.

It's not surprising when Wellington City alone has lost nearly 10,000 jobs over the past three years. There aren't enough jobs in Luxon's economy for all the young people who are desperately applying for them.

The harm falls hardest on Māori and Pasifika young people. Over 21 percent of young Māori and Pasifika are not in employment, education, or training, compared to 13.8 percent for all young people. Some regions are worse off than others. Youth unemployment in Northland is more than twice the rate in Canterbury.

A long period without a job at the start of a working life lowers a person's wages for years afterwards. Thousands of young people are in that position now. The Government can choose to have an active role in making sure there are good jobs for them, before young people are condemned to either a future of low wages or a new life in Australia.

We can choose to fix this with programmes that already work in our communities.

The Mayors Taskforce for Jobs already helps thousands of 16 to 24-year-olds into work with local employers, with support for driver licensing, training and work gear.



An economy for people and places

Local government jobs to support water infrastructure in Kāpiti

In Kāpiti, the Mayors Taskforce for Jobs supported a young person into a paid internship and then a long-term job in the Council's water and wastewater lab, giving them practical scientific experience while helping to protect essential local infrastructure.

Our Jobs for Young People programme will fund more roles like this in local government.



Hāpu partnerships to build homes in South Taranaki

In South Taranaki, Ōkahu-Inuawai Hapū partnered with WITT to train young people in construction by building new homes on hāpu whenua. The Mayors Taskforce for Jobs has helped to connect young people to this training opportunity, with rangatahi graduating with a construction qualification and supported into longer-term employment.

Our Jobs for Young People programme will fund more roles like this provided by iwi and hapu.



Restoring native landscapes in Hauraki

The Mayors Taskforce for Jobs supported a young person in Hauraki, after nine months of unemployment to get their drivers license and connect them with a role on Tiaki Whenua Trust's native planting team. This led to a permanent position with Waihi Native Plants, beginning a long-term career working to restore native forests. The local Hauraki scheme has placed dozens of young people in trade apprenticeships and other roles.

Our Jobs for Young People programme will fund more roles like this provided by non-profit organisations.



An assessment of the Mayors Taskforce for Jobs in six rural districts estimated that every dollar invested returned $5.60 in social value. It created just over 1,000 opportunities for young jobseekers in the past year.

The Green Party will fund all 67 councils to get 32,000 young people into local jobs.

Jobs for Nature, set up under the previous Government, employed more than 15,900 people over five years in pest control, planting and restoration work in their own regions.

The Green Party will widen its scope beyond conservation to create a Jobs for Young People programme.

With government providing policy direction and funding, people in each community will decide what work needs doing, whether that is restoring local bush, building climate-resilient infrastructure, or caring for people.

Every job under the guarantee will be additional, this means no job will replace an existing worker.

The Green Party will make sure every young person who wants a job has the chance to do decent work where they live.

Costings and modelling assumptions

All costings are indicative only, based on the best publicly available information.

2027/28	2028/29	2029/30	2030/31
$604m	$1,156m	$1,469m	$1,631m



The Green Party will:

Guarantee decent work for young people

- Guarantee every 16 to 24-year old who has been out of work for six months a pathway into education, training, or a new job.

Create Jobs for Young People

- Establish the Jobs for Young People pilot programme, based on the successful Jobs for Nature model, to support new jobs in businesses, councils, iwi, non-profits or the public sector.
- Empower people in each community to determine what work needs doing to ensure it addresses local needs.
- Require every job under the programme to be additional.

Fund local jobs in every district

- Get 32,000 young people into local jobs by scaling up funding of the Mayors Taskforce for Jobs for all 67 councils.
- Connect young people with local businesses, community organisations, iwi and hapū.

Plan for the future workforce

- Make sure national workforce strategies plan for young people and the future economy to ensure our workforce has the skills and experience needed to transform our economy.

Reference list

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